

There is a Miracle Looking for a Vessel

2 Kings 4:1-7

4 A certain woman of the wives of the sons of the prophets cried out to Elisha, saying, "Your servant my husband is dead, and you know that your servant feared the Lord. And the creditor is coming to take my two sons to be his slaves."

2 So Elisha said to her, "What shall I do for you? Tell me, what do you have in the house?" And she said, "Your maidservant has nothing in the house but a jar of oil."

3 Then he said, "Go, borrow vessels from everywhere, from all your neighbors — empty vessels; do not gather just a few. 4 And when you have come in, you shall shut the door behind you and your sons; then pour it into all those vessels, and set aside the full ones."

5 So she went from him and shut the door behind her and her sons, who brought the vessels to her; and she poured it out. 6 Now it came to pass, when the vessels were full, that she said to her son, "Bring me another vessel."

And he said to her, "There is not another vessel." So the oil ceased. 7
Then she came and told the man of God. And he said, "Go, sell the oil
and pay your debt; and you and your sons live on the rest."

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Introduction:

Here is a woman who has lost just about everything dear to her in her life. This is no sinner woman. This is a Woman of God whose husband was one of the sons of the Prophets. He was a man of God, training for the ministry, in the school of the Prophets. Yet the one whom she depended on for provision, cover and comfort has died. And now the creditors have come to take her boys!

I. Creditor is Come

- a. Creditors symbolize this world
- b. The boys speaks to us many things
 - i. The creditors of this world are after Godly seed...
 - ii. They will attack our children
 - iii. Our teenagers – I tell you right now I faced some stuff as a teenager but nothing in comparison to this generation
 - iv. Attacks against our Families
 - v. Attacks against the Church of the Lord Jesus
 - vi. Attacks that come after your faith, your anointing, your favor, your commitments to the Lord

Transition:

The prophet who died might not have left an insurance policy or a great wealth of money, but he left something more valuable. He left his wife the legacy of when you are in trouble find a man of God.

- Not your ways or ideas
- Find the Lord – get a hold of God
- Story of Pastor Charles Crank – “are you the man sent from God”
- Story of my Friend Ed Dittfurth – walking in and seeing me in the Hospital – unprepared.
- People need an answer from the Lord...they don't need my opinion or yours, they need God's word on the matter...so they need a man or woman of God with God's word in their mouth

II. What's in Your House

a. Her Response

i. Nothing

1. What you call nothing God calls great
2. God sees your potential, not just your situation
3. I think of this building project and I have to trust God that what we need is in the house or on the way to the house: Either way I have to trust the Lord

ii. Save this little bit of oil

1. God will use the least thing in your life to bring about the greatest miracle
2. The excepts; that which you have left; the little
3. That little bit your are holding on to or saving for a rainy day

III. Looking for Empty Vessels

- a. Empty of your agenda
 - i. We want to tell God how and when He is going to do it
- b. Empty of sin
- c. Empty of present formulas
- d. Empty of old oil
- e. God fill me, I need a miracle and God's in heaven saying, "O That I Might Find an Empty Vessel"
 - i. 2 Chron 16:9

9 For the eyes of the Lord run to and fro throughout the whole earth, to show Himself strong on behalf of those whose heart is loyal to Him.

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IV. Importance of the Vessel

- a. John 10:10

10 The thief does not come except to steal, and to kill, and to destroy. I have come that they may have life, and that they may have it more abundantly.

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b. Adam

- i. Had power because he had the nature and character of God
- ii. Had authority because he was born here, formed here, out of the substance of earth
 - 1. All of creation was spoken into existence
 - 2. Man was formed of the dust

3. God breathed spirit into him...
4. His being formed here gave him authority...
5. Example: A woman at the cross walk holds a stop sign and traffic stops or pays the penalty of violating the law...is she the law, no she stands in place of the authority of the Law

c. Alien

- i. Has no rights
- ii. No authority
- iii. Satan was a trespasser on this planet
 1. Embodied a serpent
 2. Needed a vessel, a body

d. Because of Sin

- i. Adam relinquished his power, because his character and nature were defiled, through sin and disobedience
- ii. Surrendered his Authority to the enemy...

e. God

- i. Bound to his own rules, can't just enter this world....
- ii. Because he is spirit, not man.
- iii. God desires to come to this planet in the form of a man
 1. He searches for a vessel which is empty
 2. Finds Mary
- iv. Unto us a child is born, unto us a Son is given
 1. Angels declared, Glory to God in the Highest peace on earth good will to men
- v. Jesus entered this World Legally

1. He took on God's nature, thus he as full of the Power of God
2. Luke declares: Jesus grew in favor with man and with God
3. Because he was Flesh he had legal access and authority.

vi. Confrontation with the Enemy

1. Luke 4:31-34

31 Then He went down to Capernaum, a city of Galilee, and was teaching them on the Sabbaths. 32 And they were astonished at His teaching, for His word was with authority. 33 Now in the synagogue there was a man who had a spirit of an unclean demon. And he cried out with a loud voice, 34 saying, "Let us alone! What have we to do with You, Jesus of Nazareth? Did You come to destroy us? I know who You are — the Holy One of God!"

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2. In essence the enemy was asking Jesus, what are you doing here
3. Jesus declared, legally, "I am the Son of Man." I was born here.
4. Later on in Scripture the Lord Jesus declares, "All Power and Authority I give unto you!"

5. That is why it is so important to Pray...you are asking...giving access for the things of the spirit realm authority and access in to your situation!

V. Behind Closed Doors

- a. The scripture in Kings says, “You Shall shut the door behind you and your sons”
 - i. Some Anointings only come behind closed doors
 - ii. Some Breakthroughs come when it is just you and God

VI. To Us

- a. The widow ran out of vessels and the oil quit flowing
- b. Jesus is gone, the day of Pentecost is come
 - i. Vessels are there in the upper room, empty waiting
 - ii. The oil begins to flow into those 120 vessels...
 - iii. When they received their miracle, they go and do that which Jesus did, immediately.

VII. Closing

- a. God has fresh oil, he has blessing, and he has a miracle. Do you have a vessel!
- b. 1 Cor. 3:16 says, “Ye are the Temple”
 - i. Greek word “naos” – the dwelling place of God. Where God now abides. The place the Glory of God dwells.
- c. Is your vessel clean, ready to be filled? God is in the filling business.
- d. There’s a Miracle today looking for a Vessel, will it be you...
- e. Introduce Deanna Painting – You need to know everything you need is wrapped up in the very name of God!